THE OTHER ROBIN

Cold Open

Draft 1
TSH — the opening of the game, before the player is handed control

FADE IN:

BLACK.

Rain. A low electrical hum, like a city breathing through its teeth. Somewhere far off, a siren that never arrives.

THE DIRECTOR (V.O.)
(calm, practised)
Ten years ago, the weapons got small enough to wear.

EXT. NEW YORK CITY - NIGHT

We fall through cloud.

Below, Manhattan: a grid of light under rain, towers lit from the inside. Drones drift between the buildings like slow fireflies, each with a red eye.

THE DIRECTOR (V.O.)
A ring. A bracelet. A pair of shoes.

A train crosses a bridge. Every window in it is a screen. Every screen shows the same three letters: WFC.

THE DIRECTOR (V.O.)
And the gangs wore them first.

EXT. NEON AVENUE - CONTINUOUS

Street level. Puddles hold the neon upside down.

Under a broken sign that used to say something, THREE TEENAGERS in hooded jackets wait. Bored. Restless.

One of them, JUNO (17), rolls his wrist. A bracelet wakes up on it: a ring of light, filling.

He grins at the others. Raises his arm at a shop window.

The light hits full.

WHUMP.

The window doesn't break. It EXPLODES, outward, in slow motion: a thousand pieces of glass hanging in the rain.

A GIRL (9) at the bus stop across the street covers her head. Her mother pulls her down.

THE DIRECTOR (V.O.)
Our streets became battlegrounds.
Our children grew up afraid.

Red and blue light sweeps across the girl's face.

Two armoured WFC VANS slide sideways into the avenue, one from each end. Doors slam open. WFC OFFICERS step out in a line: grey armour, mirrored visors, no faces.

Juno's friends run.

Juno doesn't. He raises the bracelet again.

A DRONE drops out of the rain right in front of him. Its red eye opens.

DRONE
Unregistered wearable detected.

The light pins him. He freezes.

THE DIRECTOR (V.O.)
The World Field Command is here to take this city back.

Officers close in around him. One of them reaches for his wrist.

THE DIRECTOR (V.O.)
To make New York safe again.

We rise away from the arrest, up the face of a building, to a BILLBOARD forty feet high:

A WOMAN in a pressed WFC uniform. Fifties. Composed. Looking down at the street like she owns it. Under her: WFC — PROTECTING NEW YORK.

She doesn't blink. The rain runs down her face like it isn't there.

SUPER: NEW YORK CITY · 2044

SMASH CUT TO:

A GUITAR RIFF, LOUD.

INT. ROBIN'S APARTMENT - BEDROOM - NIGHT

A speaker on the floor, its little lights jumping to a rock song turned all the way up.

ROBIN RYU (16) SPRINTS through frame from the kitchen, long black hair flying, socks on the floorboards, and LAUNCHES herself onto her bed.

She bounces. Lands. Bounces again, on the beat.

She's singing along. Badly. Eyes closed. She knows every word.

Her room, in flashes, cut to the music:

A WORKBENCH. A sewing machine, circuit boards, a soldering iron still smoking in its stand.

A DRESS FORM wearing a black jacket. Thin lines of light run down its sleeves like veins.

A TABLE of shipping boxes, taped and labelled. A burner phone. Cash under a coffee mug.

A pair of WHITE SNEAKERS by the window, coils visible inside the soles.

A NOTE on the kitchen table. She dances right past it.

She slides across the floor in her socks. Spins. Air-drums on the workbench with two screwdrivers.

Then she stops.

A RED ELECTRIC GUITAR leans against an amp in the corner. It's been waiting.

Robin looks at it. A slow, dangerous grin.

She grabs it, throws the strap over her shoulder, kicks the amp on.

FEEDBACK SCREAMS.

GAMEPLAY: THE GUITAR. The player plays the song. The camera moves around her the whole time, a new angle every section. On the last chord she jumps off the bed.

The last note rings out.

Robin falls backwards onto the bed, guitar on her chest, out of breath, laughing at nobody.

Silence. Just the amp humming.

Her PHONE buzzes against the mattress. She reaches for it without looking.

On the screen: CANON.

She answers, still lying down.

ROBIN
Mm.

CANON (V.O.)
(on the phone)
You alive? You missed chem. Again.

ROBIN
I was there. Spiritually.

She sits up. Gets up. She paces when she's on the phone; she always has.

CANON (V.O.)
Teacher says one more missed lab write-up and she's calling home.

Robin passes a CLOSED DOOR at the end of the hall. No light under it.

ROBIN
She can try.

(beat)
Nobody's ever home.

She keeps walking. That one cost her something, and she doesn't let him hear it.

CANON (V.O.)
You're coming tomorrow, though. I'm not building that robot by myself.

ROBIN
Yes, Canon. I'll be there.

CANON (V.O.)
On time?

ROBIN
(smiling)
Don't push it.

The phone BUZZES against her ear. A second call.

She pulls it away and looks.

INSERT - PHONE SCREEN

UNKNOWN NUMBER, sliding in over Canon's name.

BACK TO SCENE

The smile goes. Her eyes go to the table of boxes.

ROBIN
Hold on. Let me call you back. I have to do something.

CANON (V.O.)
Robin, wait—

She switches calls. When she speaks again her voice is lower. Flatter. Business.

BUYER (V.O.)
Hey. You got my order?

Robin picks a small black box off the table. Opens it with her thumb.

INSERT - THE BOX

Two rings. Plain silver. Under the metal, a faint pulse of light, like something asleep.

BACK TO SCENE

ROBIN
Yeah. It's ready.

She hangs up.

She stands in the middle of her room. The window. The sneakers. The jacket on the form.

She checks the clock on her phone: 22:15.

ROBIN
(to herself)
Okay.

She turns off the lamp.

INT. ROBIN'S APARTMENT - BEDROOM - MOMENTS LATER

The kit, piece by piece.

The JACKET comes off the dress form. She swings it on. As it settles on her shoulders, the lines in its sleeves light

up, one after another, like it's waking up with her.

At the bench, GLOVES: black, fingerless, with a dull metal sheen across the palms. She flexes her hands. They grip the air.

By the window, she kneels and laces the WHITE SNEAKERS. The coils in the soles flicker blue for half a second, then go dark.

A BANGLE snaps around her wrist with a soft click.

The BACKPACK, roll-top, slung over one shoulder. The ring box goes in the front pocket.

She heads for the door. Then stops.

INT. ROBIN'S APARTMENT - KITCHEN - CONTINUOUS

The kitchen is small and clean. Too clean. A plate on the table under a metal cover. A glass of water, untouched.

The NOTE.

She picks it up.

INSERT - THE NOTE

Neat handwriting: "Dinner's in the fridge. Love you. — Mom"

BACK TO SCENE

Robin looks at it longer than she means to.

She looks down the hall at the closed door. Dark.

She puts the note back exactly where it was. Squares it up with one finger.

INT. ROBIN'S APARTMENT - BEDROOM - CONTINUOUS

She crosses to the window and pushes it open. The city floods in: rain, sirens, the hum.

She pulls a pair of round SUNGLASSES from her jacket and puts them on. At night. Of course she does.

She climbs onto the sill.

EXT. ROBIN'S BUILDING - WINDOW LEDGE - NIGHT

Robin crouches on the sill, five storeys above KILN STREET. Below, cars hiss through the wet. Somewhere, the drones are watching somebody else.

She looks down. Way down.

Then she smiles.

ROBIN
Let's go.

She jumps.

THE CAMERA DROPS WITH HER, toward the street.

GAMEPLAY: THE SHOES. The player takes over mid-fall.

CUT TO BLACK.

END OF COLD OPEN